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Nº. 45

LIFE SITUATIONS

COLLECTION

Buying and Selling at the Same Time

Move without getting stuck — coordinate both transactions.



2026 EDITION

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Important notice

This guide is provided for informational and educational purposes only. It presents general information about real estate in Quebec and does not constitute personalized real estate, legal, tax or financial advice. Every real estate situation is different, and you should consult the appropriate professionals before making a decision about a transaction.

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Buying and Selling at the Same Time · Collection Life Situations · Guide No. 45 · 2026 Edition

COLLECTION LIFE SITUATIONS · GUIDE NO. 45

Buying and Selling at the Same Time

Move without getting stuck — coordinate both transactions

Selling your current property and buying a new one at the same time is a balancing act: financial, logistical and timing issues intertwine. Well planned, it's done peacefully.

This guide covers scenarios (sell first, buy first), tools to close the gap, and date coordination.

Each chapter ends with a lined "My Notes" page.

Selling your property and buying another at the same time is a balancing act: finances, logistics and timing are intertwined. This guide covers choosing the sequence, tools to bridge the gap, coordinating dates, and how to avoid double detention.

Well planned, the exercise becomes a simple series of mastered steps.

CHAPTER

Sell first or buy first?

> *Choose the sequence adapted to your risk.*

Everything depends on the order of operations, and each has its downside:

- **Sell first** : you know your exact budget and sell without pressure, but risk having to relocate temporarily.
- **Buy first** : you secure your next home, but risk paying for two properties if the old one is slow to sell.

The **condition of sale** (offer conditional on the sale of your property) is a tool to reduce this risk.

Everything depends on the order: sell first (exact budget known, without pressure, but risk of rehousing) or buy first (next house secured, but risk of paying for two properties). The condition of sale (offering conditionally on the sale of your property) reduces this risk.

> EMILIE'S ADVICE
>
> *If your budget can't accommodate two mortgages, lean toward "sell first" or use a condition of sale. Comfort of mind is often worth more than the perfect house found too soon.*

CHAPTER

Closing the financial gap

> *Manage the gap between the two transactions.*

If the dates do not coincide, or if you buy before cashing your sale, tools exist:

- **Bridge loan** : temporary financing until the sale is received.
- **Line of credit** : to cover a short shift.
- Negotiation of **possession dates** compatible.

The bridging loan is the most common tool: it precisely covers the gap between the purchase and the sale.

If the dates do not coincide, tools fill the gap: the bridge loan (temporary financing until the sale is cleared), a line of credit, or negotiated possession dates. Talk to your mortgage broker about the bridge loan BEFORE you make an offer.

> EMILIE'S ADVICE
>
> *Talk to your mortgage broker about the bridge loan BEFORE making an offer. Knowing that the financial bridge is possible (and at what cost) completely changes your room for maneuver.*

CHAPTER

Coordinate dates and logistics

> *Orchestrate the two closings and the move.*

The ideal is to align the **possession dates** (sale and purchase) for a smooth move.

Failing that, plan:

- From**storage** temporary.
- A **accommodation** transition.
- A **margin** in the calendar.

A broker that manages both transactions can synchronize deadlines and anticipate friction points.

The ideal is to align the possession dates for a smooth move; failing that, plan for storage, transitional accommodation and a margin in the schedule. A broker that manages both transactions can synchronize deadlines and anticipate friction.

> EMILIE'S ADVICE
>
> *Ideally entrust the purchase AND the sale to the same broker. It sees both calendars at the same time and can set the dates to avoid a double move.*

CHAPTER

Avoid costly double detention

> *Limit the risk of paying for two properties.*

The worst scenario is to end up with **two properties on the arms**. Some safeguards:

- Good **price** your current property so that it sells quickly.
- Use a **condition of sale** for purchase when possible.
- Negotiate **flexible dates** on the seller's side.
- Keep a **financial cushion** to absorb a few weeks of overlap.

Anticipating the worst scenario is precisely what prevents you from experiencing it.

The worst scenario is two properties on your hands. Guardrails: Price your current property well so it sells quickly, use a condition of sale, negotiate flexible dates and keep a cushion. Don’t overestimate “just in case”: that’s what causes sales to drag on.

> EMILIE'S ADVICE
>
> *A well-priced and well-presented property sells faster - and it's your best protection against double ownership. Don’t overestimate “just in case”: that’s what causes sales to drag on.*

CHAPTER

The game plan, step by step

> *Complete the two transactions calmly.*

A successful sequence follows a clear framework:

1. **Determine the sequence** (sell or buy first) depending on your risk.
2. **Validate financing** and explore the bridging loan.
3. **Marketing** or shop in parallel, depending on the sequence.
4. **Coordinate dates** of possession.
5. **Synchronize** the two closings at the notary.

Well planned, the balancing act becomes a simple series of mastered steps.

A successful sequence follows a framework: determine the sequence according to my risk, validate the financing and the bridge loan, market or shop in parallel, coordinate the dates, then synchronize the two closings. Write your plan on a page with key dates.

> EMILIE'S ADVICE
>
> *Write your game plan on a single page with key dates. With the big picture in hand, decisions become obvious and stress goes down.*

IN PRACTICE

Action plan

> *Your next steps, concretely.*

This week

1. Determine my sequence (sell or buy first).
2. Evaluate my ability to absorb a gap.

Within 30 days

1. Explore the bridge loan with my mortgage broker.
2. Coordinate possession dates.

Then

1. Entrust both transactions to the same broker to synchronize everything.

My game plan

1. Determine my sequence and explore the bridge loan before offering.
2. Coordinate possession dates and maintain a safety cushion.

REFERENCES

Resources & glossary

- Condition of sale: offer conditionally on the sale of your property.
- Bridge loan: temporary financing covering the gap between purchase and sale.
- Date of possession: date of possession, to be coordinated.
- Double ownership: period when one holds two properties, to be minimized.
- Sequence: sell first or buy first, depending on the risk.

- Condition of sale: offer conditionally on the sale of your property.
- Bridge loan: temporary financing covering the purchase/sale gap.
- Date of possession: date of possession, to be coordinated.
- Double ownership: period when one holds two properties, to be minimized.
- Sequence: sell first or buy first, depending on the risk.

GO FURTHER

Quiz - test yourself

1. Selling first allows you to:

A) Pay for two houses
B) Know your exact budget and sell without pressure
C) Avoid the notary
D) Double taxes

2. Buying first risks:

A) Reduce the choice
B) Charge two properties if the old one is late
C) Cancel the sale
D) Lower taxes

3. The condition of sale allows:

A) To buy without conditions
B) To offer conditionally on the sale of his property
C) To pay less
D) To avoid the notary

4. The bridging loan is used to:

A) Renovate
B) Cover the gap between the purchase and the receipt of the sale
C) Pay taxes
D) Insure the house

5. We need to talk about the bridging loan:

A) After closing
B) Before making an offer
C) Never
D) To the city

6. The ideal, in terms of dates, is to:

A) Ignore them
B) Align possession dates
C) Move twice
D) Fix at random

7. Entrusting both transactions to the same broker allows you to:

A) Pay more
B) Synchronize deadlines
C) Complicate everything
D) Avoiding the sale

8. Double detention is:

A) A tax advantage
B) Hold two properties at once, to be minimized
C) Insurance
D) A condition

9. The best protection against double detention is:

A) Overvalue your property
B) Well priced so that it sells quickly
C) Do not sell it
D) Wait for winter

10. A good game plan ideally includes:

A) In ten binders
B) On a page with key dates
C) In the head only
D) At the notary

Answers

1. B - Known budget (chap. 1).
2. B - Risk of double detention (chap. 1).
3. B - Risk reduction tool (chap. 1).
4. B - Temporary financing (chap. 2).
5. B - Anticipate financing (chap. 2).
6. B - Aligning possessions (chap. 3).
7. B - Coordination (chap. 3).
8. B - To be limited (chap. 4).
9. B - Good price = quick sale (chap. 4).
10. B - Overview (chap. 5).

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You now have the right keys in hand.

Every real estate journey is different.

If you would like to go further,
I would be happy to discuss
your project with you.



Make informed decisions.
Choose with confidence.
Live without regrets.
See you soon,
Emilie ☺

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